

LOUISIANA STATE POLICE CRIME LABORATORY
FORENSIC BIOLOGY SECTION

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FORENSIC LABORATORY REPORT — BIOLOGICAL EVIDENCE

Case No.: PBPB-2026-034532 | Document No.: 10

Lab Case No.: LASP-CL-2025-B-04492

Submitting Agency: Pelican Bay Police Department

Submitting Officer: Det. Yvette Landry, Badge #1887

Date Received: October 4, 2025

Date of Report: October 12, 2025

Reporting Analyst: Damari T. Lin, MS — Senior Forensic Biologist

Technical Reviewer: Dr. Priya Subramanian, PhD — DNA Technical Leader

Analytical Methods: Quantifiler Trio (qPCR); GlobalFiler 24-locus STR; ABI 3500xL

I. ITEMS RECEIVED FOR ANALYSIS

Lab #	PBPD #	Description
B-01	E-01	White t-shirt, heavily bloodstained — from victim
B-02	E-06	Right hand fingernail scrapings — from victim
B-03	E-07	Left hand fingernail scrapings — from victim
B-04	E-08	Anterior neck bloodstain swab — from victim
B-05	E-09	Primary blood pool sample
B-06	E-10	Wall bloodstain swab, 8 ft N of body
B-07	E-12	Cigarette butt, partially smoked — Marlboro Red
B-08	E-15	Single hair, blonde, ~8 cm — from victim's collar
B-09	AUT-1	Postmortem femoral blood — victim reference
B-10	BUC-TC	Buccal swab — TRENT CORMIER, taken pursuant to SW-2025-1144 on 10/10/2025
B-11	BUC-MP	Buccal swab — MARCO PELLEGRINO, taken pursuant to SW-2025-1145 on 10/10/2025
B-12	BUC-KR	Buccal swab — KYLE ROBICHEAUX, taken pursuant to SW-2025-1146 on 10/10/2025

II. RESULTS — BLOOD IDENTIFICATION & ATTRIBUTION

B-04, B-05, B-06 (anterior neck swab; primary blood pool; wall bloodstain): All tested positive for human blood by Hemastix presumptive and ABACard Hematrace confirmatory. STR profiles obtained from each are concordant with the reference profile from B-09 (victim Damari Thornton). **The blood at the scene is attributed to Damari Thornton.**

B-01 (victim's t-shirt): Multiple bloodstains; all tested are concordant with B-09 (victim). No foreign blood component identified above analytical threshold.

III. RESULTS — FINGERNAIL SCRAPINGS (B-02 / E-06, B-03 / E-07)

B-02 (right hand scrapings): A mixed DNA profile was obtained, consisting of two contributors. The major contributor profile is concordant with B-09 (victim Damari Thornton). A minor contributor profile, partial but suitable for comparison (18 of 23 loci with concordant results), was obtained. The minor profile was searched against the three reference samples B-10, B-11, B-12 with the following results:

- **TRENT CORMIER (B-10): EXCLUDED.**

- **MARCO PELLEGRINO (B-11): INCLUDED.** The probability of randomly selecting an unrelated individual from the U.S. Caucasian population whose DNA profile would also be included as a contributor to the mixture is approximately

1 in 4.3 billion.

- **KYLE ROBICHEAUX (B-12): EXCLUDED.**

Interpretation: Marco Pellegrino cannot be excluded as the minor contributor to the right-hand fingernail scrapings from Damari Thornton. The statistical weight strongly supports inclusion.

B-03 (left hand scrapings): Single-source profile concordant with B-09 (victim). No foreign DNA detected above analytical threshold.

IV. RESULTS — HAIR (B-08 / E-15)

Single hair, blonde, telogen root present. Mitochondrial DNA (HVI/HVII) was sequenced and compared to reference samples.

- **MARCO PELLEGRINO (B-11): EXCLUDED.**

• **KYLE ROBICHEAUX (B-12): INCLUDED.** The hair shares an mtDNA haplotype with Robicheaux. The haplotype occurs at a frequency of approximately 1 in 1,140 in the relevant population database (EMPOP, U.S. Caucasian, n=14,602). Mitochondrial inheritance is maternal; this finding is consistent with but not conclusive of the hair originating from Robicheaux.

- **TRENT CORMIER (B-10): EXCLUDED.**

V. RESULTS — CIGARETTE BUTT (B-07 / E-12)

Saliva DNA was recovered from the filter end. Single-source STR profile obtained.

• **TRENT CORMIER (B-10): INCLUDED** as the source. The probability of randomly selecting an unrelated individual with this STR profile is approximately **1 in 312 trillion** (U.S. Caucasian population).

- Other references: EXCLUDED.

VI. CHAIN OF CUSTODY AND QUALITY CONTROL

All samples were received in sealed condition with intact tamper-evident packaging. Chain of custody documentation is complete and on file (Exhibit B-COC-001). Reagent blanks, positive controls (9947A), and negative controls were processed alongside case samples; all controls performed as expected. This laboratory is accredited under ANAB ISO/IEC 17025; all reported results have undergone administrative and technical review.

Reporting Analyst: _____ M.T. Lin, MS

Technical Reviewer: _____ P. Subramanian, PhD

Section Supervisor: Dr. Yvonne Castellan, PhD — 10/12/2025